

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DPS

Date: 5/16/2026

Bill Number: HB 117

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): COMMERCIAL FISHING; SET GILLNET COOP

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

The Department of Public Safety supports this legislation as it provides additional tools to support enforcement and monitoring within Alaska's commercial fisheries while maintaining coordination with existing federal electronic monitoring systems. The bill also establishes clearer administrative boundaries for Cook Inlet set net fisheries, which may improve regulatory clarity and assist with consistent enforcement efforts by the Alaska Wildlife Troopers.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

This bill authorizes the Department of Fish and Game to require participation in an electronic monitoring program for a state commercial finfish trawl fishery under specified conditions and establishes a new administrative area for certain commercial set net entry permits in Cook Inlet, including a transition process for permit reassignment and appeal.

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The Department of Public Safety, through the Alaska Wildlife Troopers, is responsible for enforcing commercial fishing laws and regulations. Enforcement related to the provisions of this bill would fall within the department's existing authorities and operational responsibilities. Electronic monitoring provisions may require the Alaska Wildlife Troopers to access and review large volumes of data maintained by third party contractors, federal programs, or other entities.

The structure of data storage, ownership, access protocols, and any associated retrieval costs have not been defined and may vary depending on how the program is implemented. Access to this data may be necessary for investigative purposes, but the frequency and method are unknown at this time.

The Cook Inlet administrative area changes and associated permit reassignment process are administrative matters assigned to other agencies and do not create new enforcement responsibilities for the Department of Public Safety beyond existing operations.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 Legislative Findings

Adds uncodified legislative findings stating that it is in the public interest to establish a new administrative area on the east side of Cook Inlet.

Section 2 Amends [AS 16.05.050\(a\)](#) *Powers and duties of commissioner*

Adds a new duty authorizing the commissioner of Fish and Game to require vessels registered under AS 16.05.475 to participate in an electronic monitoring program for state commercial finfish trawl fisheries, if certain written findings are made. The commissioner must determine that participating vessels already have federally required electronic monitoring equipment, that no additional equipment purchase or installation is required, and that electronic monitoring is practical, not unduly disruptive, reasonably costed, and capable of coordination with federal monitoring programs.

Section 3 Amends [AS 16.05.050](#) by adding subsection (c)

Prohibits the commissioner from levying an assessment or charge on participating commercial fishers to fund the implementation or operation of an electronic monitoring program authorized under Section 2.

Section 4 Amends [AS 16.43.200](#) *Limited entry permits*

Requires the Alaska Commercial Fisheries Entry Commission to establish certain east side Cook

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Inlet set net statistical areas as a distinct administrative area, separate from the Cook Inlet administrative area. Provides that an existing Cook Inlet set net entry permit does not authorize fishing in the new administrative area unless the commission reassigns the permit to that area.

Section 5 Transition: Regulations

Authorizes the Department of Fish and Game to adopt regulations necessary to implement the electronic monitoring provisions in Sections 2 and 3. The regulations may take effect under the Administrative Procedure Act, but not before the effective date of the law being implemented.

Section 6 Transition: Reassignment of certain Cook Inlet area set net entry permits

Establishes the process for reassignment of certain Cook Inlet set net entry permits on January 1, 2027. Permit holders may be reassigned to the new administrative area if they provide satisfactory proof of participation, or qualifying immediate family member participation, in the identified east side Cook Inlet statistical areas within the five years preceding December 31, 2024.

Section 7 Transition: Appeal of commission decision

Allows an individual to appeal a Commercial Fisheries Entry Commission decision not to assign their permit to the new administrative area. The appeal must be filed in superior court on or before March 1, 2027, and the commission must provide a provisional entry permit for the new administrative area during the appeal.

Section 8 Immediate effective date

Provides that Section 5, relating to transition regulations, takes effect immediately.

Section 9 Effective date

Provides that the rest of the Act takes effect January 1, 2027.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

Rider Bill: SB 158 COOK INLET: NEW ADMIN AREA

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

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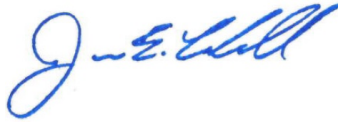
Rider Bill: [SB 158 Letters of Opposition 4.7.26 \(2\).pdf](#), [SB158 Letters of Support 2.12.26.pdf](#)

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

DPS defers to DFG.

Commissioner's Signature: _____



Date: _____

May 16, 2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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